

XRationals.jl

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Exact rational arithmetic with IEEE-like special values (NaN, Inf, -Inf), overflow-safe saturation, and lazy normalization for impressive throughput.

Types

Type	Alias	Backing	Overflow	Normalization
XRational32	Qx32	Int32	Saturates to Inf/NaN	Lazy (Int64 intermediate)
XRational64	Qx64	Int64	Saturates to Inf/NaN	Lazy (Int128 intermediate)
XRational128	Qx128	Int128	Saturates to Inf/NaN	Lazy (Int256 intermediate)
XRational256	Qx256	Int256	Saturates to Inf/NaN	Lazy (Int512 intermediate)
XRational512	Qx512	Int512	Saturates to Inf/NaN	Lazy (Int1024 intermediate)

Features

- Exact rational arithmetic with no floating-point rounding
- IEEE-like NaN, Inf, -Inf encoded in the same struct ($0//0$, $1//0$, $-1//0$)
- Overflow saturates to Inf/NaN instead of crashing (Qx types)
- Lazy GCD normalization: deferred until display, hashing, or conversion
- 3-13x faster than Rational{Int} for chained arithmetic
- Fused multiply-add (fma) with exact intermediate computation
- Cross-width narrowing (Qx512 -> Qx256, Qx512 -> Qx128, Qx512 -> Qx64, Qx512 -> Qx32, Qx256 -> Qx128, Qx256 -> Qx64, Qx256 -> Qx32, Qx128 -> Qx64, Qx128 -> Qx32, Qx64 -> Qx32) via best rational approximation
- Exact widening across exported extended types through constructor-first APIs (Qx64(x::Qx32), Qx128(x::Qx32), Qx128(x::Qx64), Qx256(x::Qx32), Qx256(x::Qx64), Qx256(x::Qx128), Qx512(x::Qx32), Qx512(x::Qx64), Qx512(x::Qx128), Qx512(x::Qx256)), with convert and widen following the same width ladder
- Zero heap allocation: all arithmetic uses fixed-width integers (Int32/Int64/Int128/Int256/Int512/Int1024/Int2048)
- typemin rejection prevents silent negation overflow

Examples

See Use.jl for examples.

Benchmarks

The package includes a runnable benchmark harness at test/Benchmark.jl:

```
julia --project=. test/Benchmark.jl
```

It compares Qx32, Qx64, Qx128, Qx256, and Qx512 against Rational{Int32}, Rational{Int64}, Rational{Int128}, Rational{Int256}, and Rational{Int512} using Chairmarks.

Representative local results from that harness:

Qx32 vs Rational{Int32}

Operation	Rational{Int32}	Qx32	Speedup
a + b	13 ns	2 ns	7.0x
a * b	8 ns	2 ns	4.2x
a / b	7 ns	2 ns	3.6x
muladd(a,b,a)	25 ns	3 ns	7.5x
a+b+c+d	66 ns	5 ns	14.3x
a*b-c*d	40 ns	4 ns	10.1x

Qx64 vs Rational{Int64}

Operation	Rational{Int64}	Qx64	Speedup
a + b	14 ns	3 ns	5.3x
a * b	9 ns	2 ns	4.0x
a / b	8 ns	3 ns	3.2x
muladd(a,b,a)	28 ns	6 ns	4.6x
a+b+c+d	72 ns	8 ns	9.4x
a*b-c*d	43 ns	5 ns	8.2x

Qx128 vs Rational{Int128}

Operation	Rational{Int128}	Qx128	Speedup
a + b	75 ns	7 ns	10.4x
a * b	65 ns	6 ns	10.8x
a / b	60 ns	7 ns	8.9x
muladd(a,b,a)	144 ns	12 ns	11.7x
a+b+c+d	269 ns	20 ns	13.2x
a*b-c*d	216 ns	17 ns	12.5x

Qx256 vs Rational{Int256}

Operation	Rational{Int256}	Qx256	Speedup
a + b	267 ns	23 ns	11.4x
a * b	230 ns	16 ns	14.3x
a / b	208 ns	19 ns	11.1x
muladd(a,b,a)	438 ns	38 ns	11.4x
a+b+c+d	996 ns	69 ns	14.5x
a*b-c*d	791 ns	53 ns	14.8x

Qx512 vs Rational{Int512}

Operation	Rational{Int512}	Qx512	Speedup
a + b	583 ns	93 ns	6.3x
a * b	461 ns	59 ns	7.9x
a / b	417 ns	64 ns	6.5x
muladd(a,b,a)	941 ns	156 ns	6.0x
a+b+c+d	2.1 us	310 ns	6.8x
a*b-c*d	1.7 us	222 ns	7.9x

fma is the main exception: the exported Qx types route finite fused multiply-add through a slower exact-or-canonical path before converting back to the fixed-width representation, while Rational just performs muladd. If you do not need that guarantee, muladd is the faster path.